

PRINT, REFILL, PRINT

Don't sell your printer for a new cartridge—refill the old one instead



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An entry-level printer, today, costs no more than Rs 3,000, and that's a great price for a home printer. But that's not the ownership cost, as the hidden costs that surface once you start using the printer will tell you. Cartridges are exorbitant, and sometimes cost nearly as much as the printer itself.

Under such conditions, refills are economical. We tried refilling a cartridge to see if the kits you get provide as good print quality, without harming the

printer. Various kits are available in the market, and we settled on the most popular and easily available—the one from Lipap.

The cartridges we used for the test were from the HP DeskJet 3550—our value winner in the home category for April 2004. We printed various kinds of document, such as pure text documents, text-and-picture documents and photographs. We then compared the results to those obtained using the original cartridges.

What you need

- An appropriate cartridge refill kit—available at your local hardware vendor
- A sharp blade or cutter
- A cleaning cloth or tissue paper

Preparation

Before refilling, get all the materials in one place. Remove the refill bottles from the kit, unwrap them and keep a cleaning cloth or tissues handy, for accidental spills.

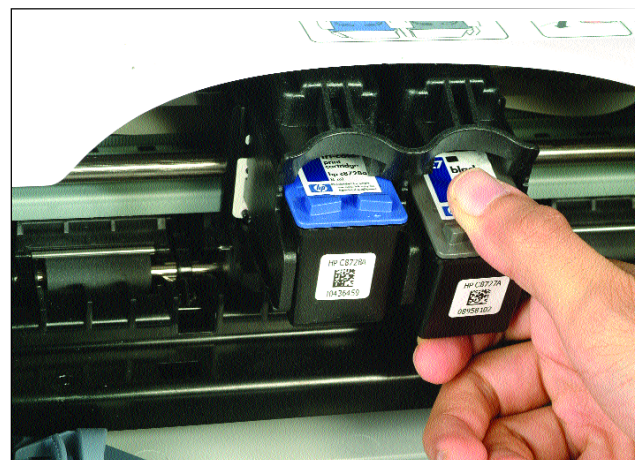
Removing cartridges from the printer

These steps pertain to the HP 27A and 28A cartridges that are used in the HP DeskJets 3550 and 3650. For other printers, please refer to their respective manuals.

STEP 1 Switch on the printer and lift the top lid. The carriage assembly centres itself right in the middle, allowing for easy access to the cartridges.

STEP 2 To remove the cartridges, apply some gentle pressure in the downward direction, and then pull the cartridge towards you.

STEP 3 Place the cartridges upside down, or on their sides, on a table.



Pull out the cartridges without applying force

TIPS

- Do not apply force—just a gentle push in the downward direction is enough to release the cartridges from their locked position.
- Do not place the cartridges with their ink nozzles facing the table. Nozzles are delicate and are likely to be damaged.